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Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 6, 2025 • \$4

Maryland surges law officers to Baltimore

Mayor, governor act to combat crime as Trump threatens to send troops

BY DANA MUNRO
AND ERIN COX

With President Donald Trump's threat to send National Guard troops into Baltimore in the air, Maryland leaders said Friday that they will pour more of their own resources to further bring down crime in the state's largest city.

The open-ended increase in public safety efforts, announced by Gov. Wes Moore (D) and Mayor Brandon Scott (D), builds on an existing partnership that has already funneled cash to violence-interrupter groups and state prosecutors, an effort that the two men credit with helping drive Baltimore's homicide count to its lowest in 50 years.

"We can do this ourselves," Scott said Friday evening at a joint news conference with the governor outside St. John's Evangelical Lutheran Church. "We do not need an occupation. We do not need troops on our streets."

He called the city's population "a resource to be invested in, not a problem to be solved."

Trump has characterized Baltimore as a "hellhole" and pointed to the city, along with Chicago and New Orleans, as a place he may want to replicate his intervention in D.C., where he declared a "crime emergency" Aug. 11 and sent nearly 2,200 National Guard troops alongside a surge of

SEE BALTIMORE ON A14

In D.C.: Few large-scale protests, but many forms of resistance. B13

Miller rises as key enforcer in president's D.C. takeover

A behind-the-scenes glimpse of a trusted aide steering a top priority

BY EMILY DAVIES
AND NATALIE ALLISON

From the head of the conference table in the White House's Roosevelt Room, Stephen Miller was in the weeds of President Donald Trump's takeover of policing in the nation's capital.

The White House deputy chief of staff wanted to know where exactly groups of law enforcement officers would be deployed. He declared that cleaning up D.C. was one of Trump's most important domestic policy issues and that Miller himself planned to be involved for a long time.

Miller's remarks were described to The Washington Post by two people with knowledge of the meeting who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal White House business. The result is a behind-the-scenes glimpse of one of Trump's most trusted aides in action, someone who has emerged as a key enforcer of the D.C. operation in the month since Trump federalized the local

SEE MILLER ON A14

Congress: As Trump's 30 days run out, no plans on an extension. B13



CAIMI & PICCINNI

People on an LGBTQ+ pilgrimage to the Vatican take a lunch break during their 80-mile trek in central Italy on Aug. 30.

Pilgrimage a test of faith — and Leo

LGBTQ+ Catholics meet for Vatican-approved Mass as many await pope's stance on divisive topic

BY ANTHONY FAIOLA
AND STEFANO PITRELLI
IN SONNINO, ITALY

They'd paused by a brook three hours into their 80-mile trek to Rome, but now it was time to move.

"Andiamo," shouted a 30-year-old historian from Bologna donning a gold crucifix. When not on Catholic pilgrimages, he does nightclub drag and faithfully attends Mass. Nearby, a transitioning trans woman from Belgium searching for the courage to come out at her parish lumbered to her feet. A few steps away, a Neapolitan math teacher who seeks God daily and hates the "hookup"

pressure on gay dating sites stood and lifted a wooden rainbow cross.

The trekkers, following an ancient holy route to the seat of the Roman Catholic Church, had made pilgrimages before. But never one like this. Within six days, they would join more than 1,300 other LGBTQ+ Catholics for a Vatican-sanctioned event that many of them had believed impossible.

The church has long condemned homosexuality, the practice of which its teachings describe as "intrinsically disordered" and "evil." Yet, under Pope Francis, the Holy See quietly authorized a first: an LGBTQ+ pilgrimage for the Holy Year jubilee — the once-a-quarter-century gatherings that

draw millions of Catholics to Rome.

This weekend, now under a new pope, Leo XIV, the gay pilgrimage will proceed.

LGBTQ+ Catholics were welcomed Friday at a prayer vigil inside Rome's baroque Church of the Gesù, mother church of the Jesuit order. Accompanied by about 35 priests, one of Italy's most prominent bishops is set to officiate on Saturday an official LGBTQ+ jubilee Mass. Later, just like other Catholic pilgrims during the jubilee year, the event's hundreds of participants will seek God's salvation by passing through the sacred Holy Door at St. Peter's Basilica.

"This is a watershed moment," said Inno-

SEE PILGRIMAGE ON A8

Harvard gets a win, but war with Trump goes on

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA,
JOANNA SLATER
AND LAURA MECKLER

A federal judge's ruling Wednesday was a resounding win for Harvard — a sweeping finding that the Trump administration had violated the Constitution in freezing federal research funding to the school. It was immediately cheered by faculty, alumni and student groups, with many urging Harvard to keep fighting.

But despite the victory, Har-

Administration has many tactics for attack after school's court victory

vard faces daunting hurdles in its standoff against an administration determined to force change on higher education, and the final outcome for the nation's oldest university is far from clear.

The challenges are unprece-

ented: They include a promised appeal in court, worry that the government will slow-walk restoring frozen research funds, threats to future grants, complicated settlement negotiations — and the prospect of 3½ more years of a hostile White House with a bevy of arrows in its quiver and a proven willingness to aim them at its opponents.

The Trump administration, which has already opened numerous investigations at Harvard, has threatened to revoke its nonprofit

status and to bar international students and scholars from campus.

On Thursday it signaled new plans to eventually "streamline" the process of denying funding for schools found to have violated civil rights law.

"Yesterday's court ruling is a victory for Harvard," said Allison Wu, a Harvard Business School graduate who leads a group of alumni, the 1636 Forum, that has pressed the university to change.

SEE HARVARD ON A4

Growth in jobs lags over summer

JUNE LOSSES A FIRST SINCE PANDEMIC

Slowdown is a temporary blip, Trump says

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY
AND ABHA BHATTARAI

The U.S. labor market created few jobs in August and shrank earlier in the summer, a first since the pandemic, as the economy's engine sputters under the weight of President Donald Trump's policies.

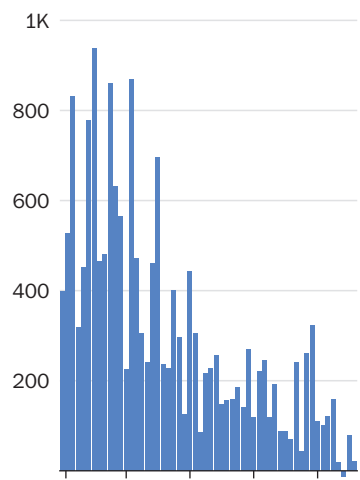
Employers added 22,000 jobs in August, far fewer than expected, the Bureau of Labor Statistics reported Friday. The unemployment rate ticked up to 4.3 percent, the highest since late 2021.

The drop-off capped four months of significantly slower jobs growth, a turning point after steady gains the past few years. Until now, economists have largely credited the job market's resilience for keeping the country out of a recession. But with hiring slowing and industries across the economy — including manufacturing, construction, professional and business services, and the government — cutting jobs in August, there are growing concerns that the labor market's decline could set off broader economic trouble.

"At this point, the job market is at stall speed," said Claudia Sahm,

SEE JOBS ON A12

Monthly change in non-farm jobs



Seasonally adjusted; the figures for the most recent two months are preliminary
Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics



ELIJAH NOUVELAGE/BLOOMBERG/GETTY IMAGES

Workers in Georgia assemble Hyundai vehicles in June. Most of those arrested are from South Korea.

Nearly 500 arrested in raid at Hyundai factory

Worksite operation in Georgia is largest to date under this administration

BY MARIANNE LEVINE
AND LAUREN KAORI GURLEY

Federal law enforcement agents this week raided a Hyundai factory in Bryan County, Georgia, arresting hundreds of immigrant workers in the largest worksite raid in President Donald Trump's second term.

A total of 475 people were arrested in the operation, which took place Thursday, authorities said at a news conference on Friday. Steven Schrank, special agent in charge of Homeland

Security Investigations in Atlanta, called it the "largest single-site enforcement operation" in the agency's history. (At least one coordinated worksite raid by federal agencies in Trump's first term resulted in more arrests.)

The majority of those arrested Thursday were South Korean nationals, Schrank said, adding that some workers had crossed the border illegally and others did not have permission to work or had overstayed their visas. Hyundai is a major international auto company based in Seoul that operates two automotive manufacturing plants in the United States. The other is in Montgomery, Alabama.

"This was not an immigration operation where agents went into the premises, rounded up

SEE HYUNDAI ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Landmark AI settlement Anthropic agreed to pay \$1.5 billion in a class-action lawsuit that alleged the company downloaded millions of books without permission. A5

Arrests in congressional intern's death Two teens were charged with murder in the slaying of Eric Tarpinian-Jachym in June. B13

THE NATION
A judge blocks Trump officials from stripping Haitians, Venezuelans of protected status. A3
Mexican parade plans in Chicago have been disrupted by Trump's Guard threats. A3

THE WORLD
Floods have devastated a region of Pakistan where tourists came to escape the heat. A6
Yemen faces a humanitarian crisis after U.S. strikes, sanctions and aid cuts. A10

THE ECONOMY
Maybe you like using artificial intelligence chatbots but don't love companies harnessing your data to "train" their AI or mining records of your conversations. Well, it's not perfect, but a web browser and search engine company has a hack for that. A9

STYLE
A heartrending drama at the Venice Film Festival draws from the tragedy of a 6-year-old girl in Gaza — and recordings of pleas for help. B1

SPORTS
Carlos Alcaraz rolls past Novak Djokovic in straight sets to reach the U.S. Open final. B7

THE REGION
A man illegally in the U.S. was charged with murder in the death of a missing 19-year-old Maryland woman. B13
The Richmond zoo announced that six cheetah cubs born in May — and adored by their mother — can now be seen by the public. B18

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